

Digital Self- Diagnosis

The Impact of Social Media on Mental Health Self-Diagnosis



Our Team



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Problem Overview

- Increasing number of people **self-diagnosing** mental health conditions through social media
- Easy access to medical content **without professional supervision**
- **Potential risks:** misdiagnosis, self-treatment, and delayed professional help
- Young people (18-24) are the most affected group



project Goals



IDENTIFY

The most commonly self-diagnosed mental health conditions — ADHD, Anxiety, Depression, and more.



ANALYZE

Google search trends for mental health topics across a 5-year span, from 2021 to 2026.



UNDERSTAND

User behavior, emotional impact, and engagement patterns around self-diagnosis content.



MEASURE

Perceived risk levels and how often self-diagnosis leads to real professional consultation.



RECOMMEND

Actionable, practical steps for platforms, content creators, and everyday users.

Datasets Overview

Survey Data – 355 responses about self-diagnosis behavior

Google Trends – Mental health search interest from 2021 to 2026

Behavioral Dataset – 5000 records linking social media usage with mental state

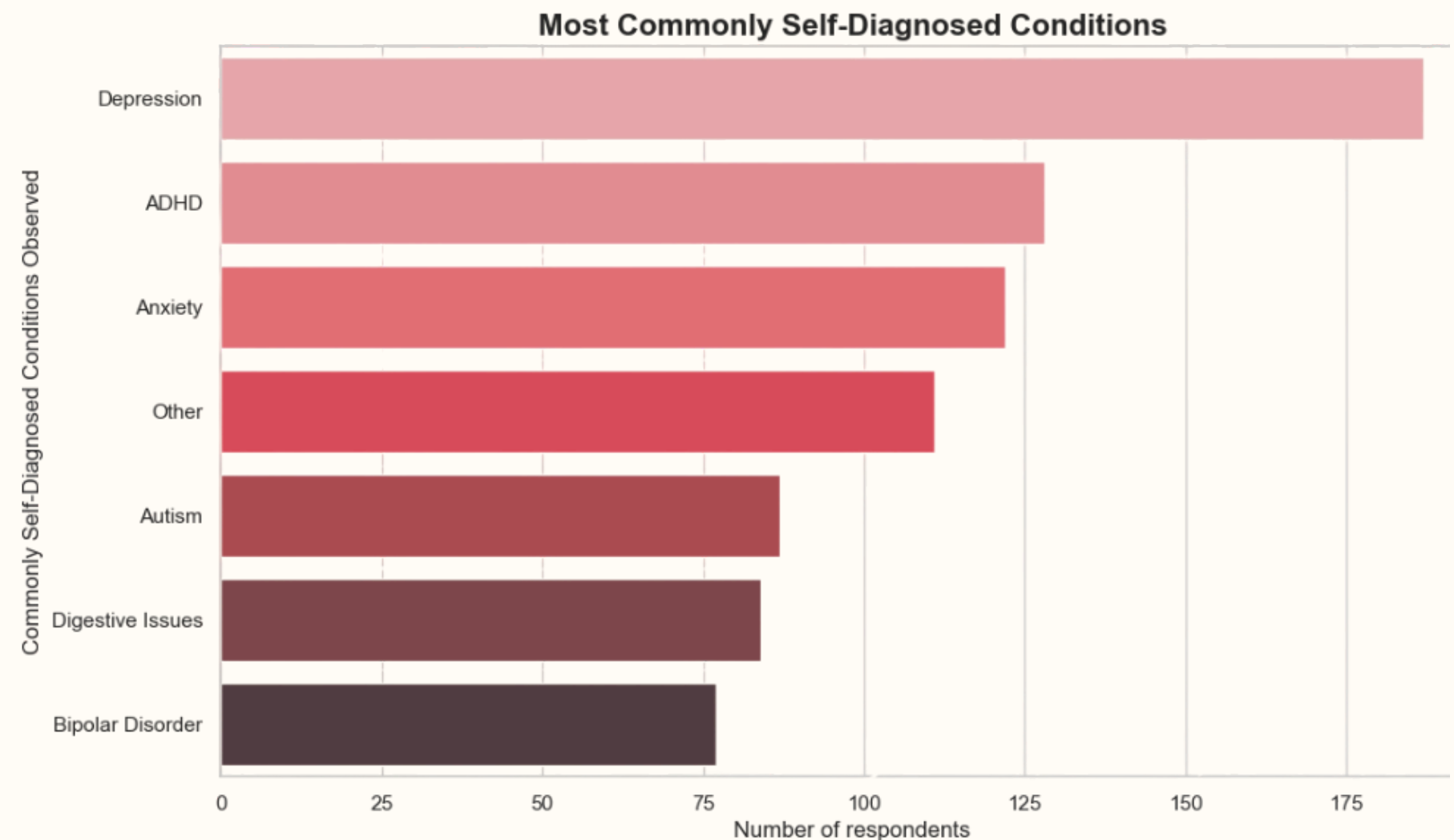
Key Findings



Get Enough Sleep

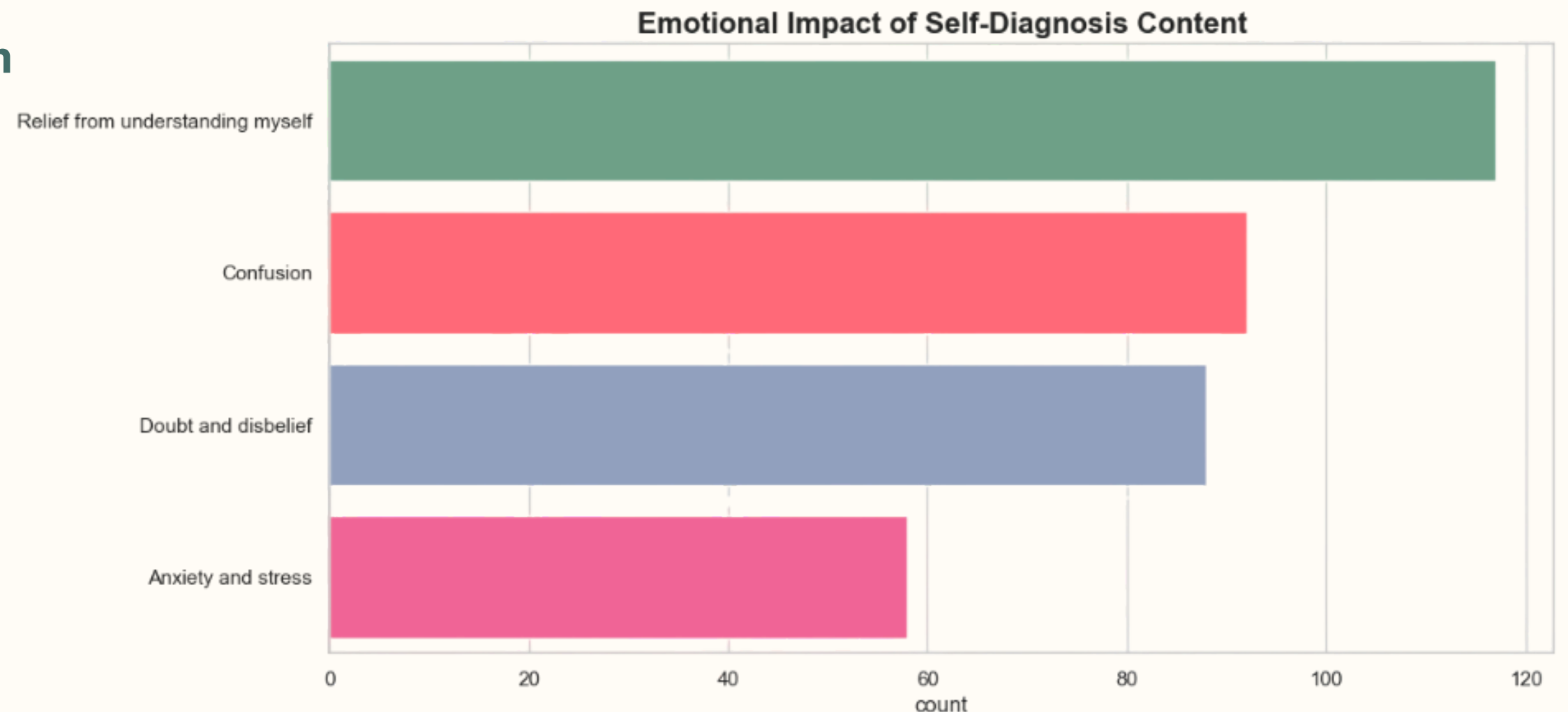
Top Self-Diagnosed Conditions

- Depression is the **most commonly** self-diagnosed condition (**187 responses**)
- ADHD and Anxiety follow as the second and third most reported
- More than **half of the participants** self-diagnosed at least one mental health condition
- Young adults (**18-24 years**) made up 83% of all responses



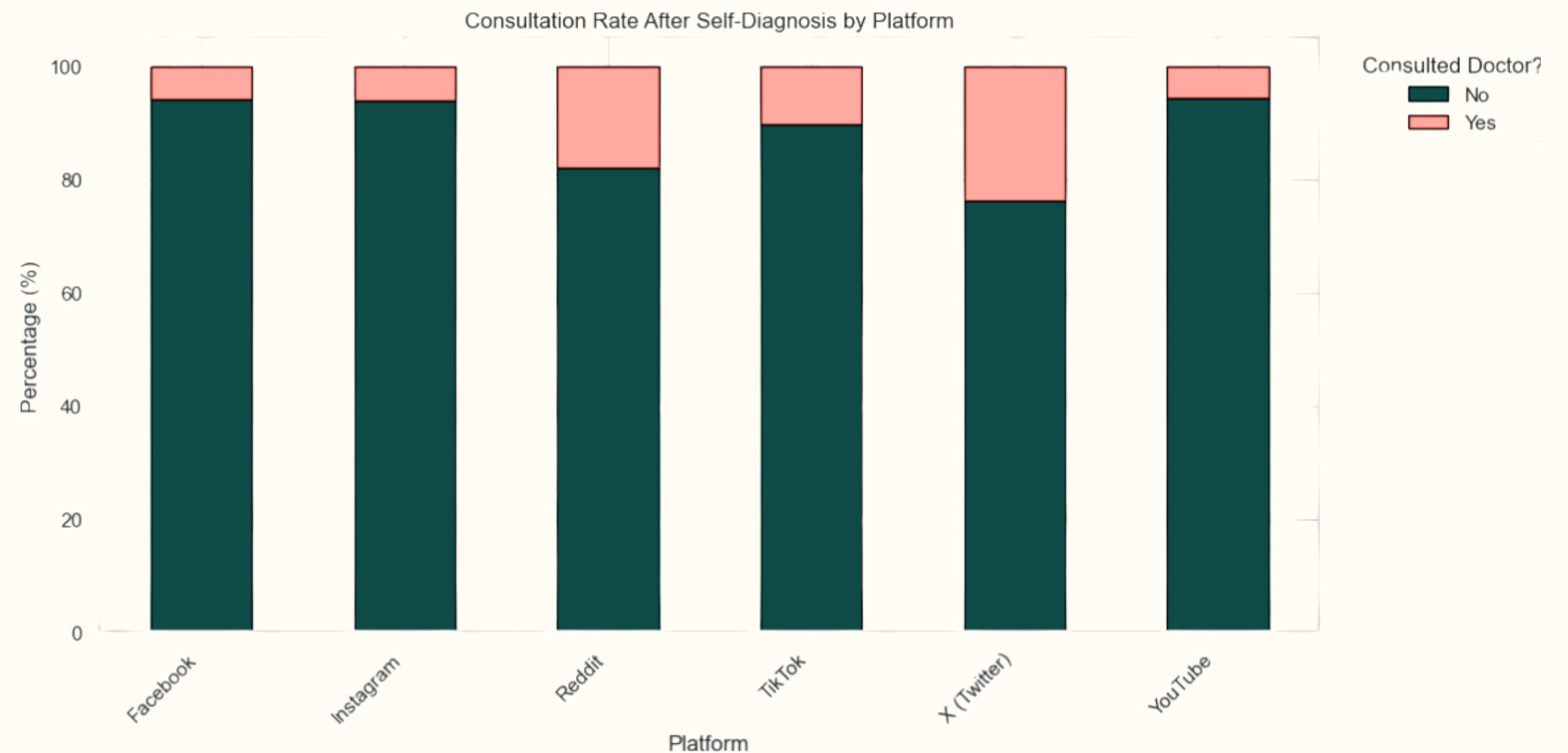
Emotional Impact of Self-Diagnosis Content

- **33%** experienced Relief from understanding themselves
- **Many** participants reported Doubt, Confusion, or Anxiety
- **25.9%** felt Anxiety and Stress after watching self-diagnosis videos
- **Negative emotions** are more common than positive ones

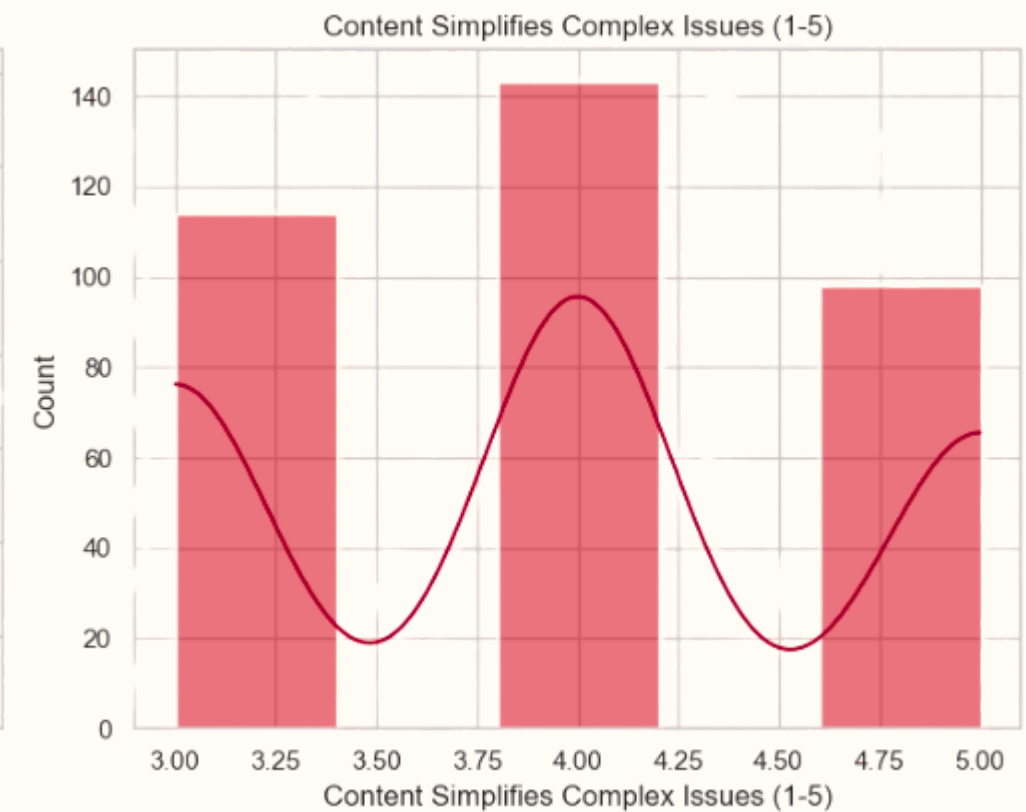
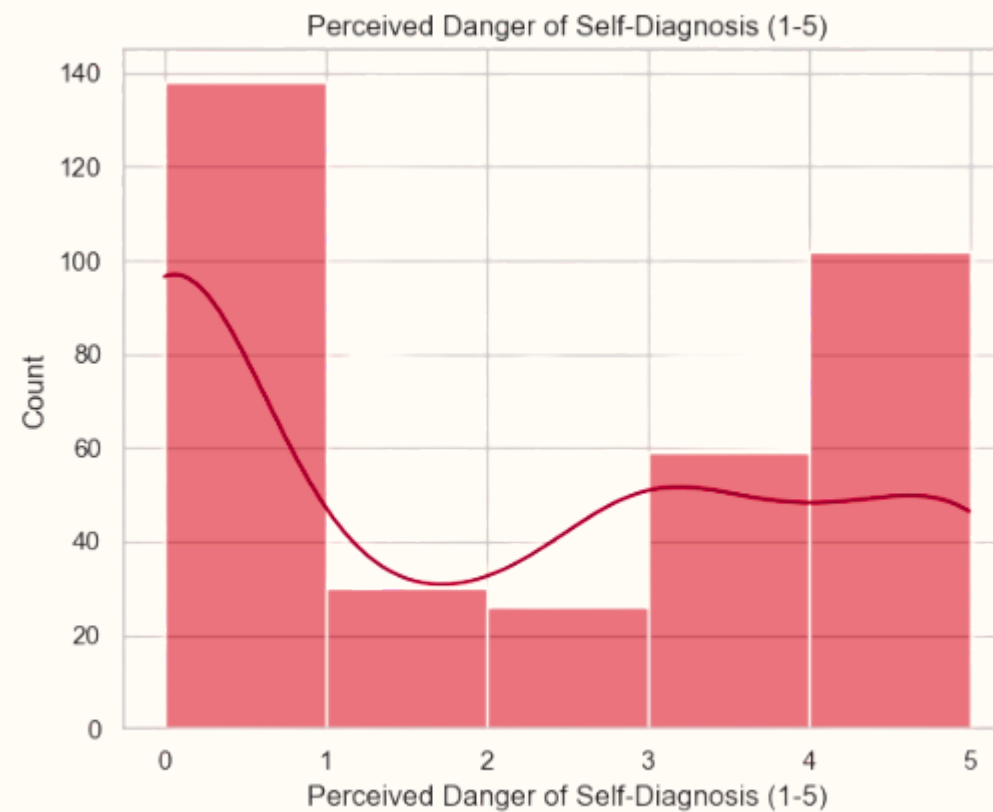
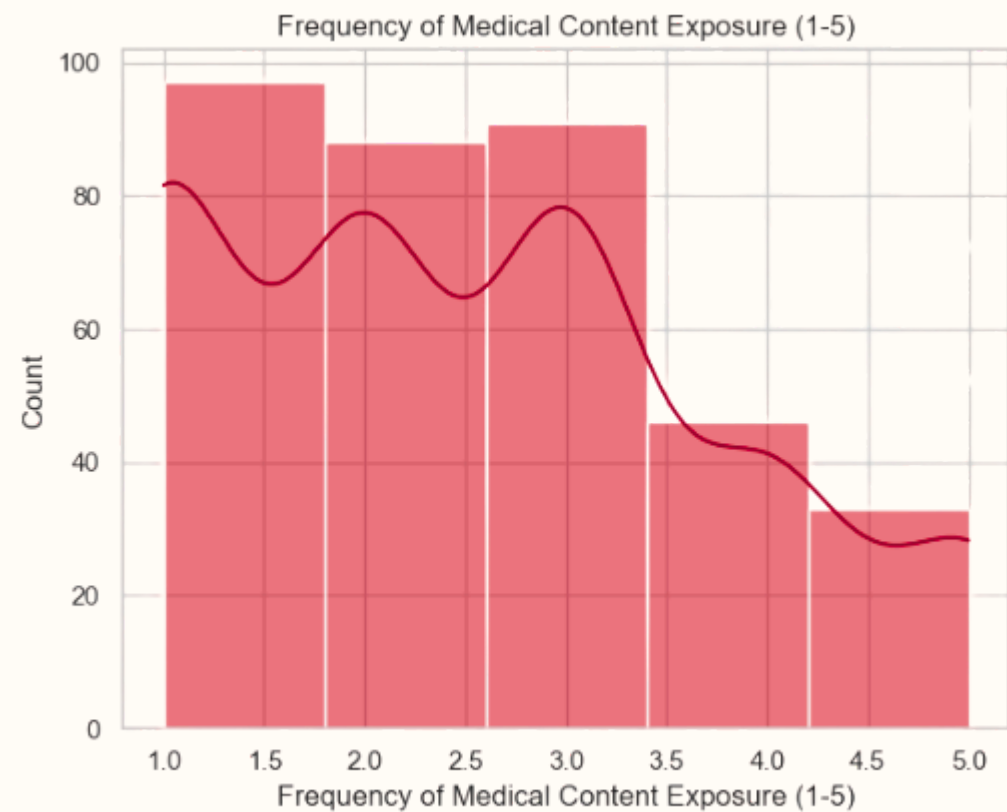


Professional Consultation Rate by Platform

- **Only 9.6%** of participants consulted a doctor after self-diagnosis
- Facebook and YouTube users **showed the lowest consultation rates**
- X(Twitter) and reddit users were slightly **more likely** to seek professional help
- Most people **do not verify the content** or seek medical advice



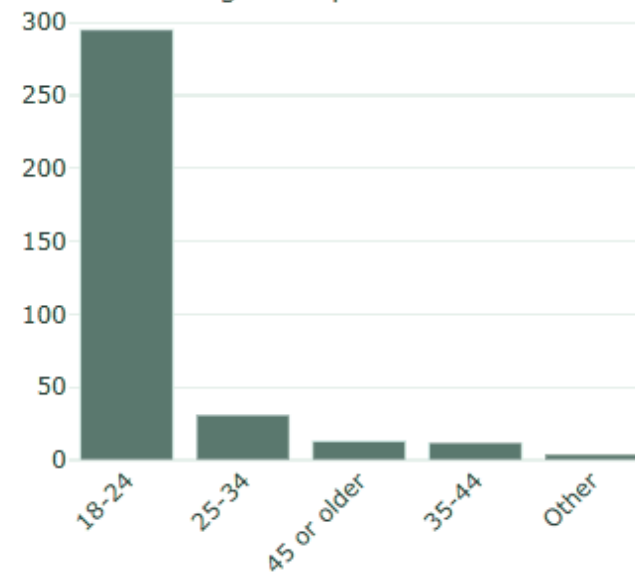
How Respondents Perceive Self-Diagnosis Content



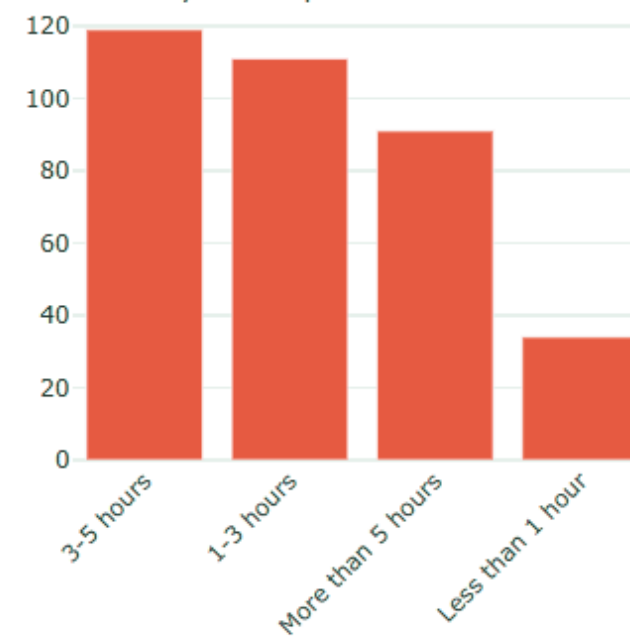
- Most respondents are frequently exposed to medical content online.
- Many recognize self-diagnosis as risky despite its popularity.
- Medical content often simplifies complex health information.

Survey Overview: Social Media Self-Diagnosis Dashboard

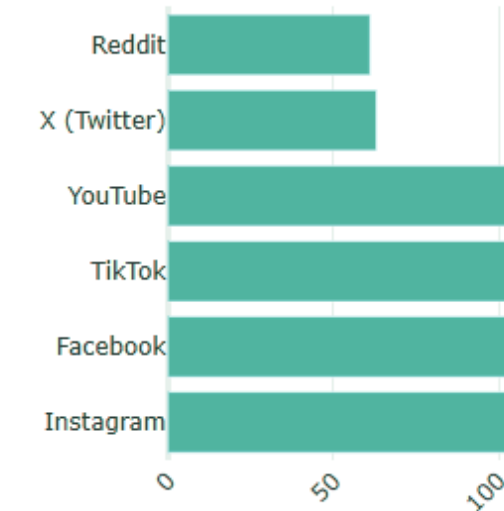
Age Group Distribution



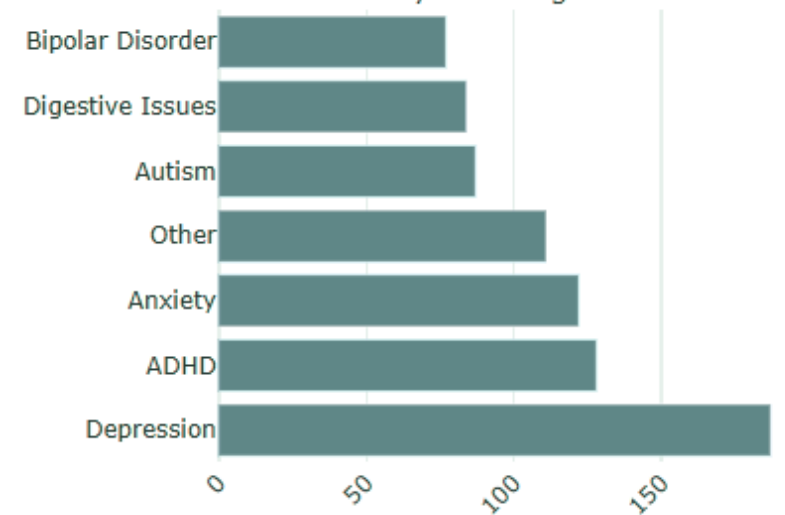
Daily Time Spent on Social Media



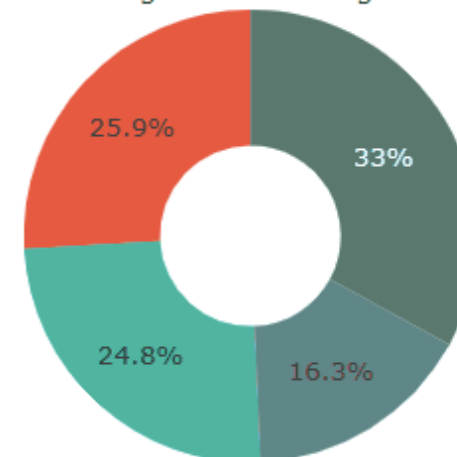
Most Used Plat



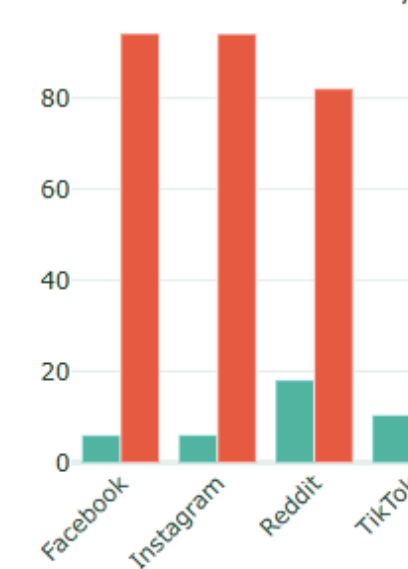
Most Commonly Self-Diagnosed Conditions



General Feeling After Self-Diagnosis Content

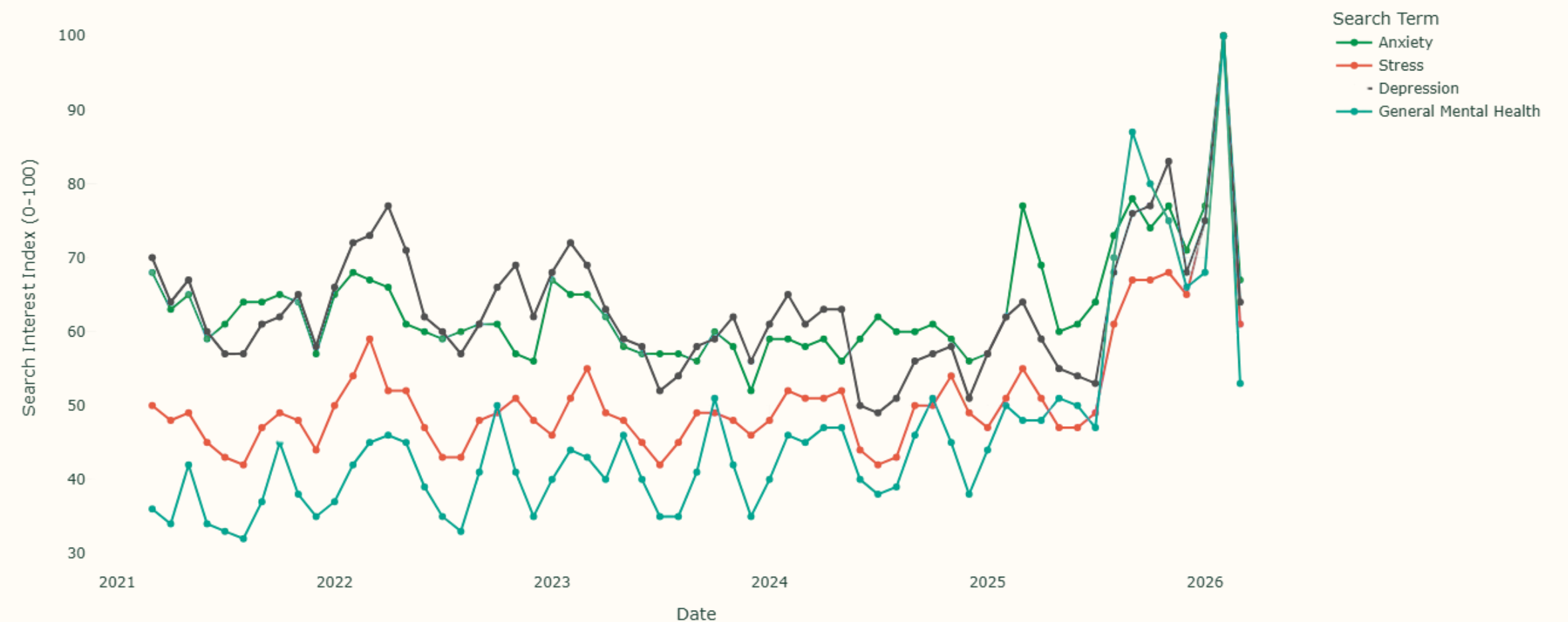


Consultation Rate by



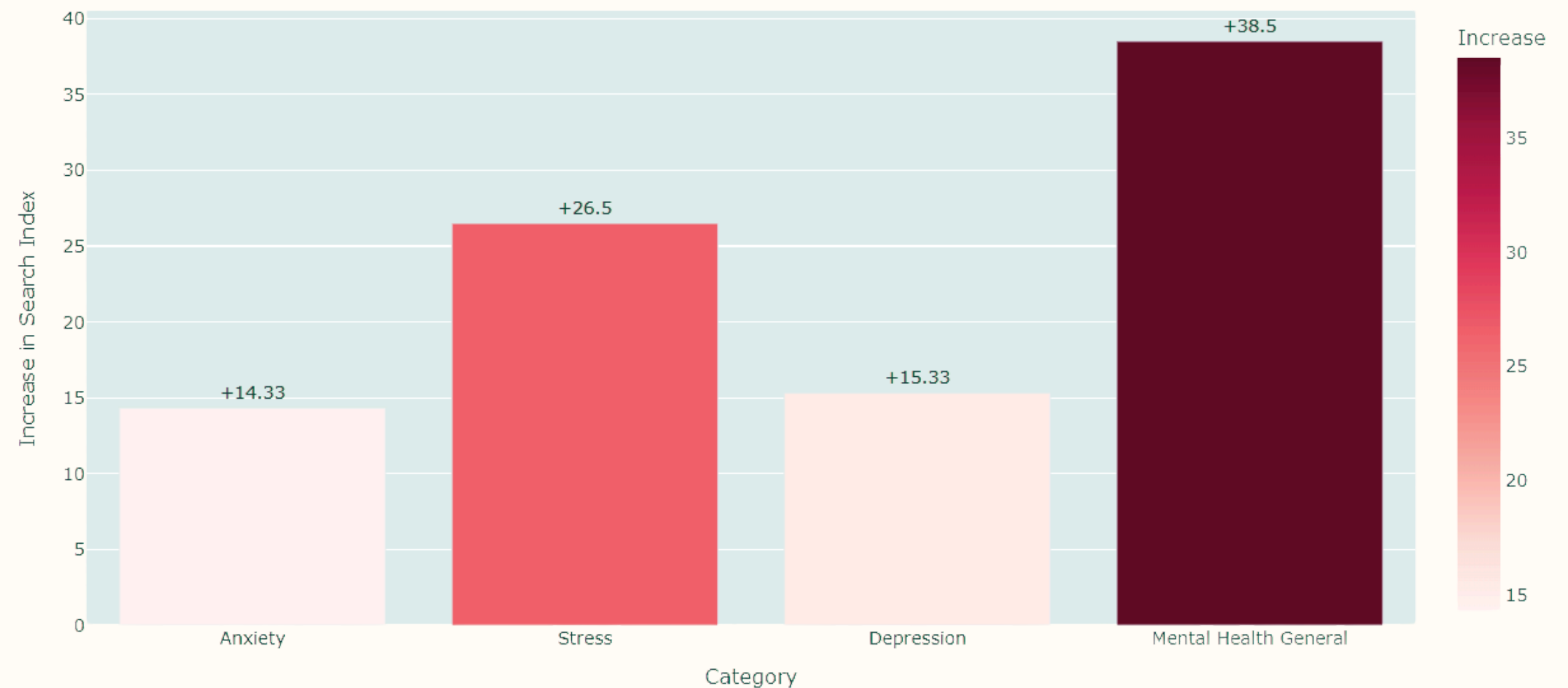
Google Trends: Mental Health Search Interest (2021–2026)

- **Steady rise in mental health searches over 5 years**
- **Dramatic peak in February 2026 across all categories**
- **Anxiety and Depression consistently highest**



Recent Trend: Last 6 Months vs First 6 Months

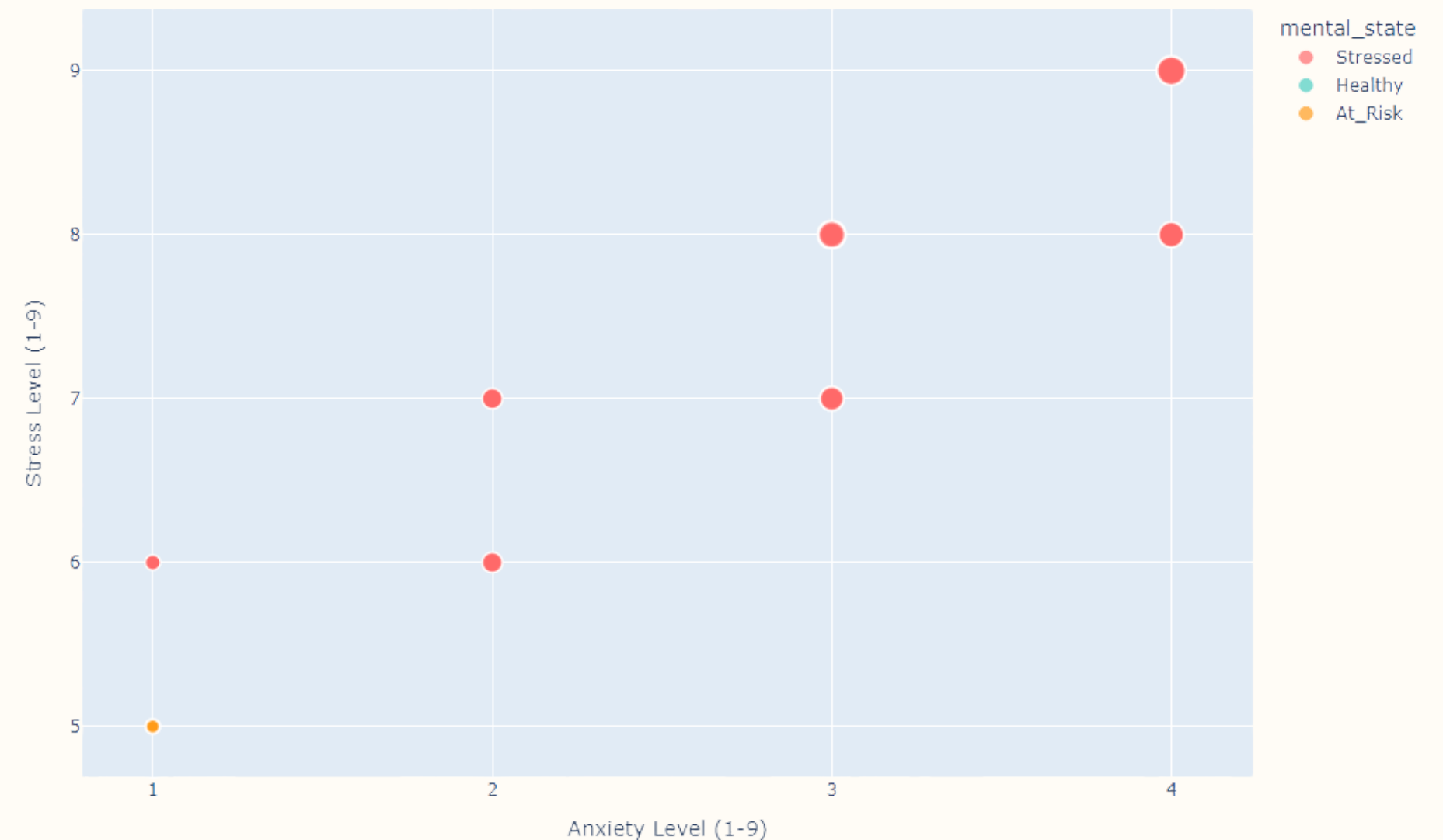
- Strong growth in all categories over the last 6 months
- Mental Health General saw the **biggest jump (+38.5)**
- Stress increased significantly **(+26.5)**



Mental health searches accelerated sharply in the most recent period

Anxiety vs Stress Level by Mental State

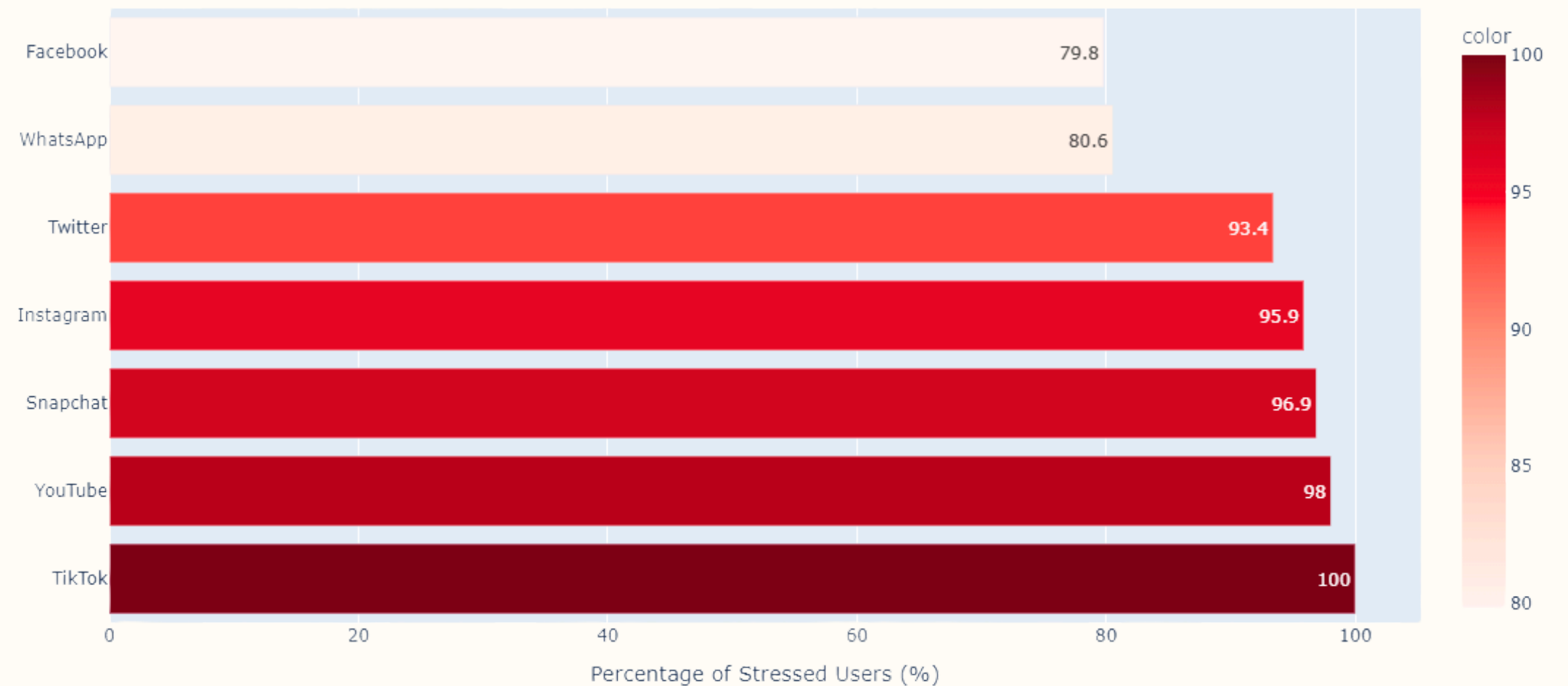
- **92%** of users are classified as **Stressed**
- **Higher social media time = higher anxiety & stress**
- **TikTok and Instagram show the strongest correlation with stress**



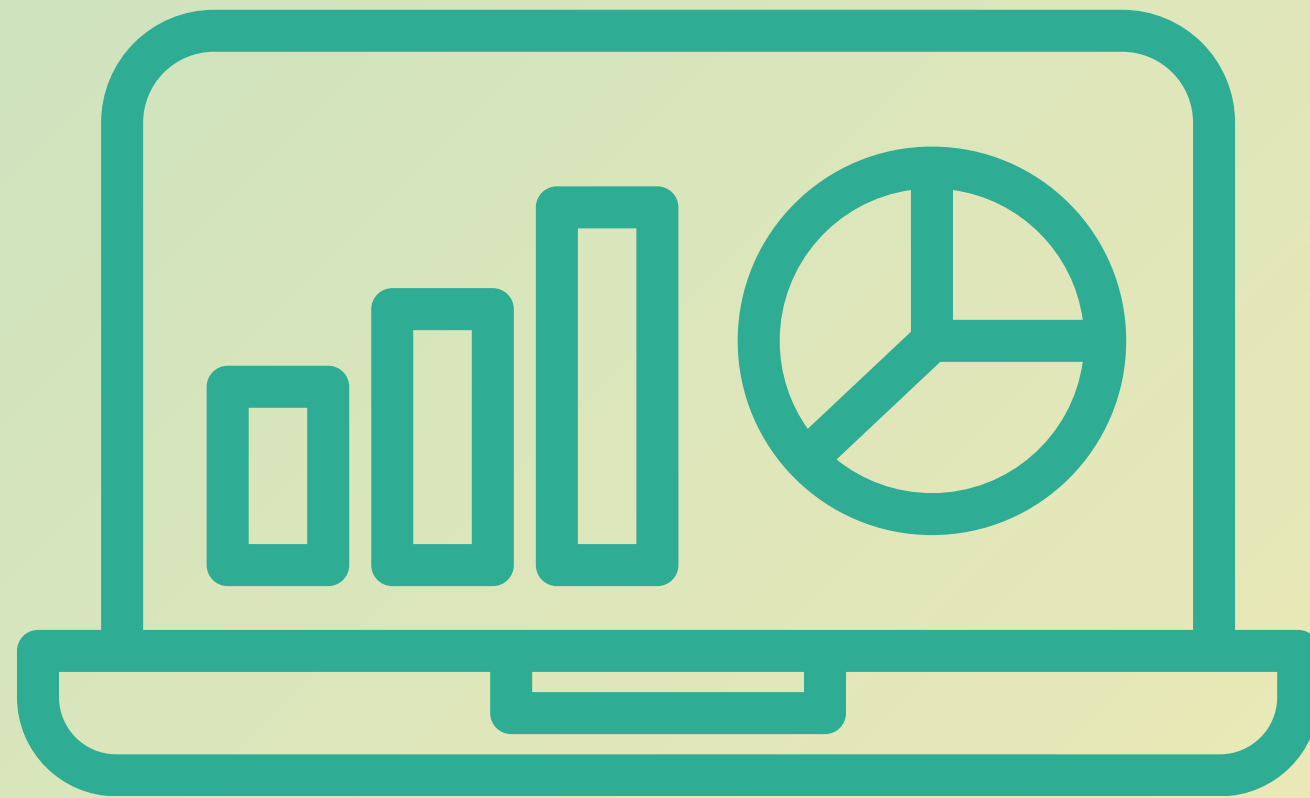
**The more time spent on social media, the higher the stress
and anxiety**

Stressed Users by Platform (%)

- TikTok have the highest percentage of stressed users
- Clear link between platform and mental state risk



**Next, let's take a look
at our Dashboard**



Digital self diagnosis Dashboard

Age Group

All



32.27

% Self Diagnosed

3.7 hours

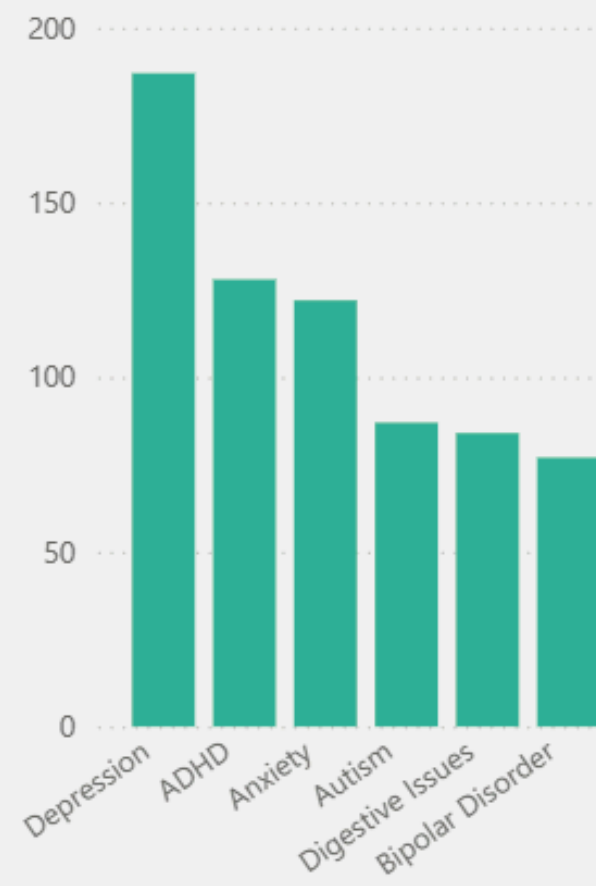
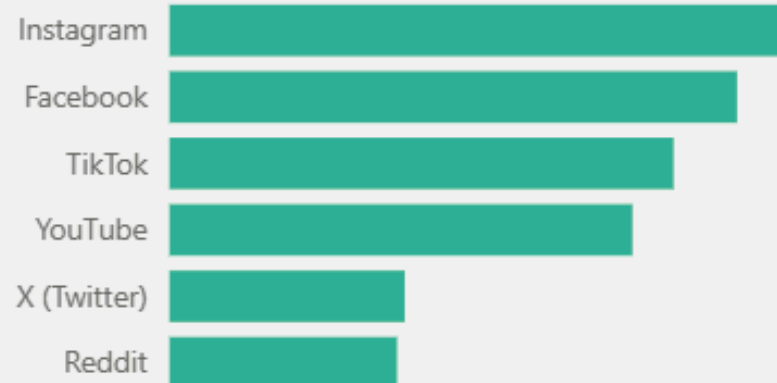
Average Daily Time

3.30

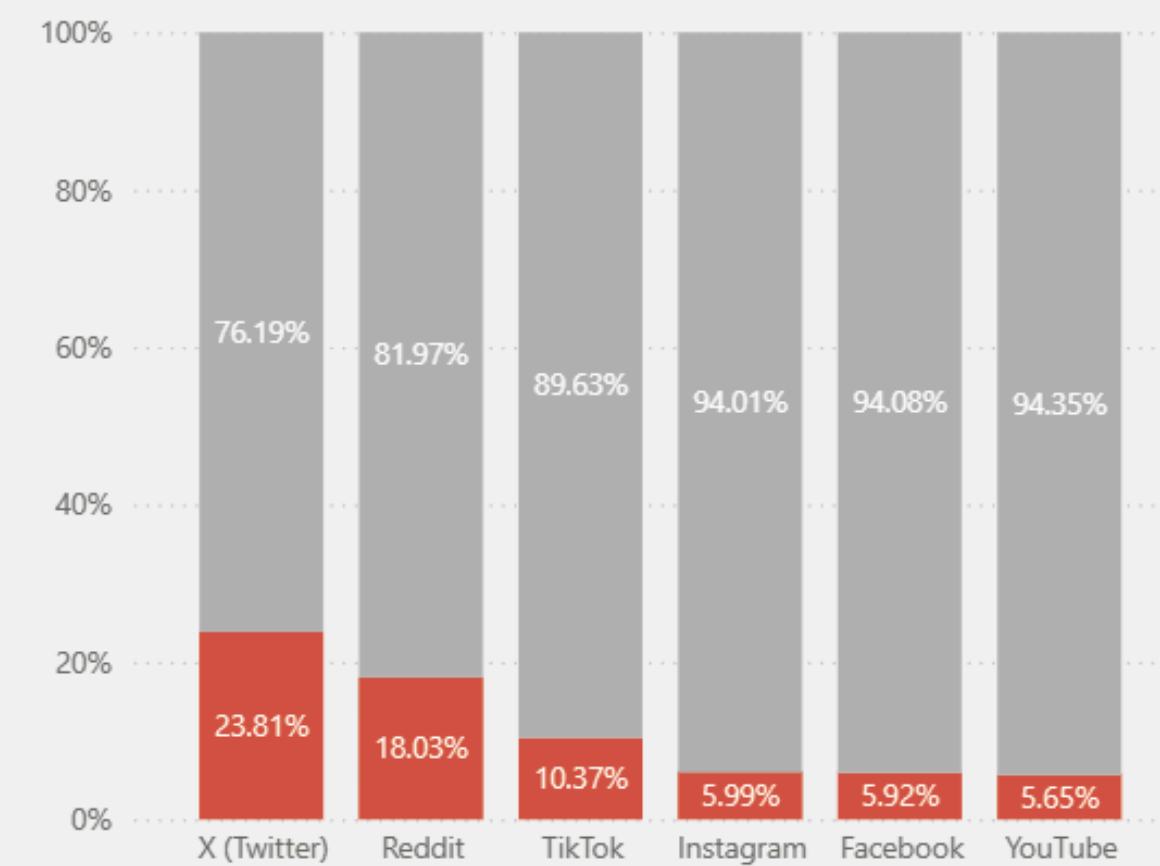
% Took Medication

11.60

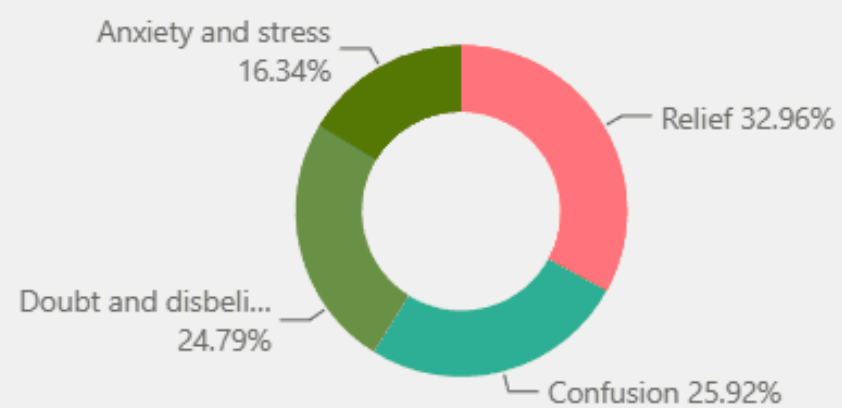
% Rely on Social Media

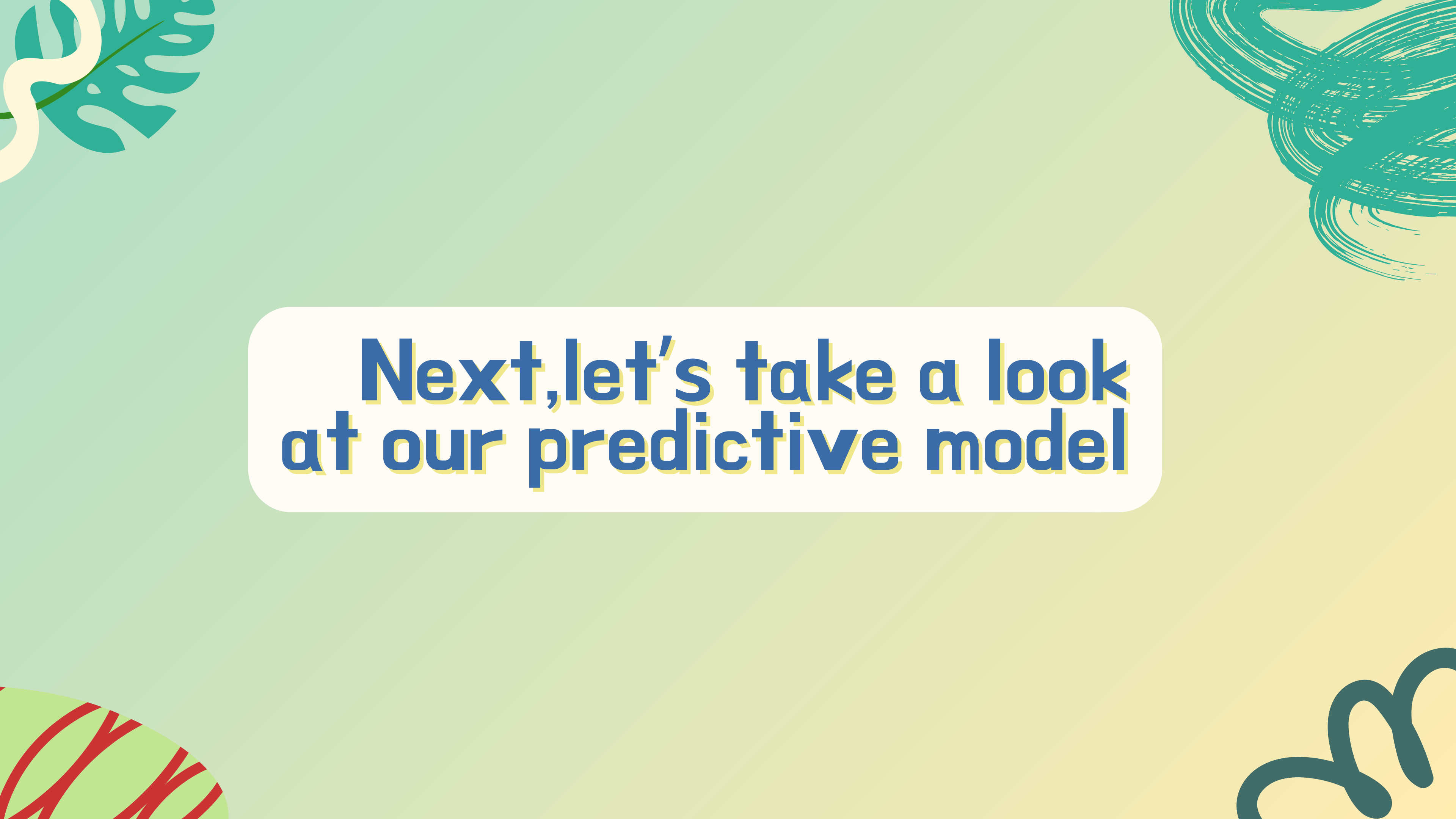


Consulted a doctor



Feeling after self-diagnosis





**Next, let's take a look
at our predictive model**

Our Approach: Building the Predictive Model

Goal

Predict whether a person who self-diagnoses will go on to consult a real professional — Yes or No.

Model

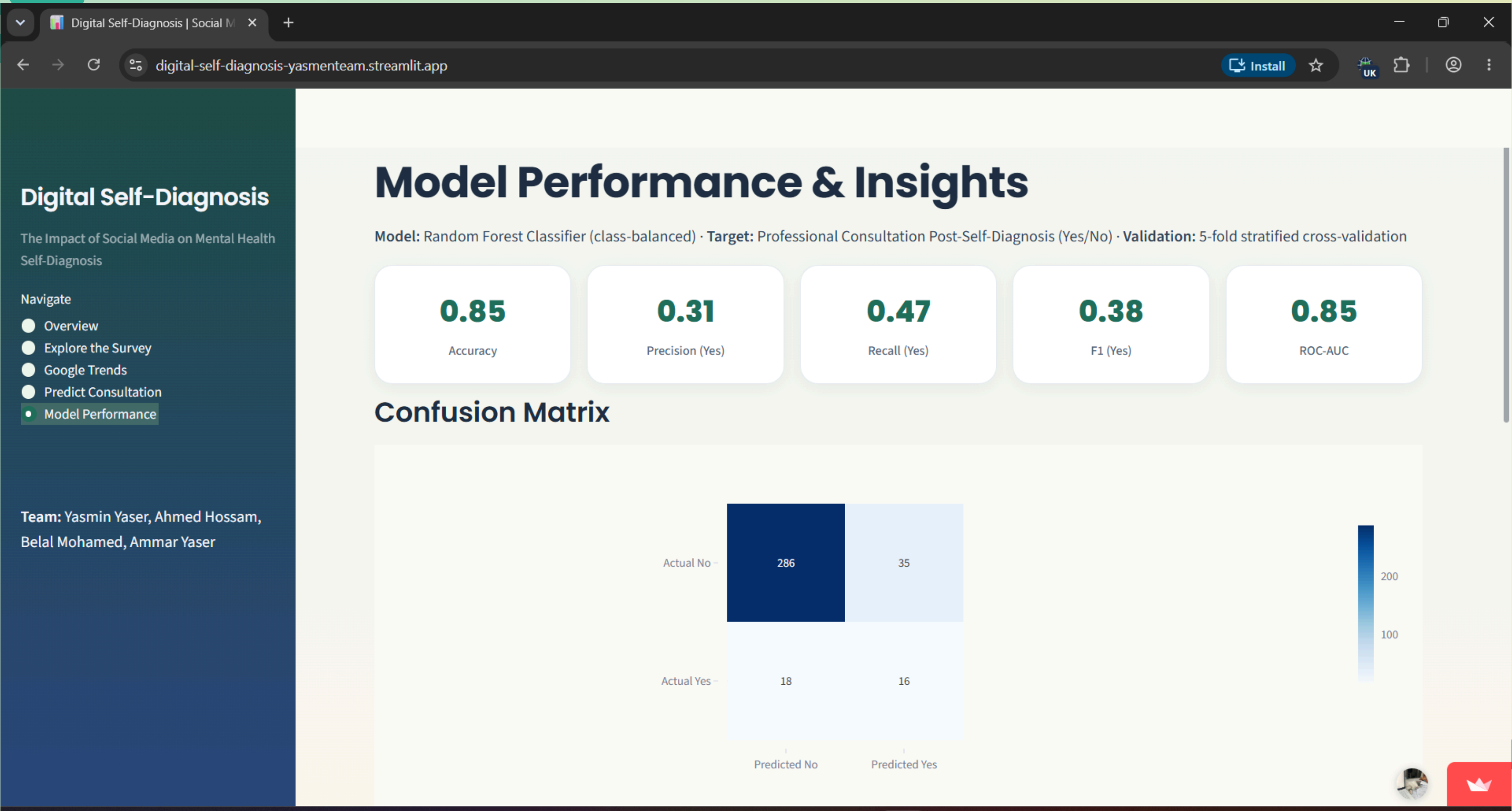
Random Forest Classifier, class-balanced to give fair weight to the minority group who did consult a doctor.

Target Variable

Professional Consultation Post-Self-Diagnosis (Yes / No), based on 355 real survey responses.

Validation

5-fold stratified cross-validation — every respondent is tested on exactly once, for a fair, reliable score.



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Install

Digital Self-Diagnosis

The Impact of Social Media on Mental Health Self-Diagnosis

Navigate

Overview

Explore the Survey

Google Trends

Predict Consultation

Model Performance

Team: Yasmin Yaser, Ahmed Hossam, Belal Mohamed, Ammar Yaser

Digital Self-Diagnosis

The Impact of Social Media on Mental Health Self-Diagnosis

A growing number of people are self-diagnosing mental health conditions through social media, often without professional supervision — with risks of misdiagnosis, self-treatment, and delayed professional help.

355

Survey Responses

3.6 hrs

Avg. Daily Social Media Time

9.6%

Consulted a Doctor After

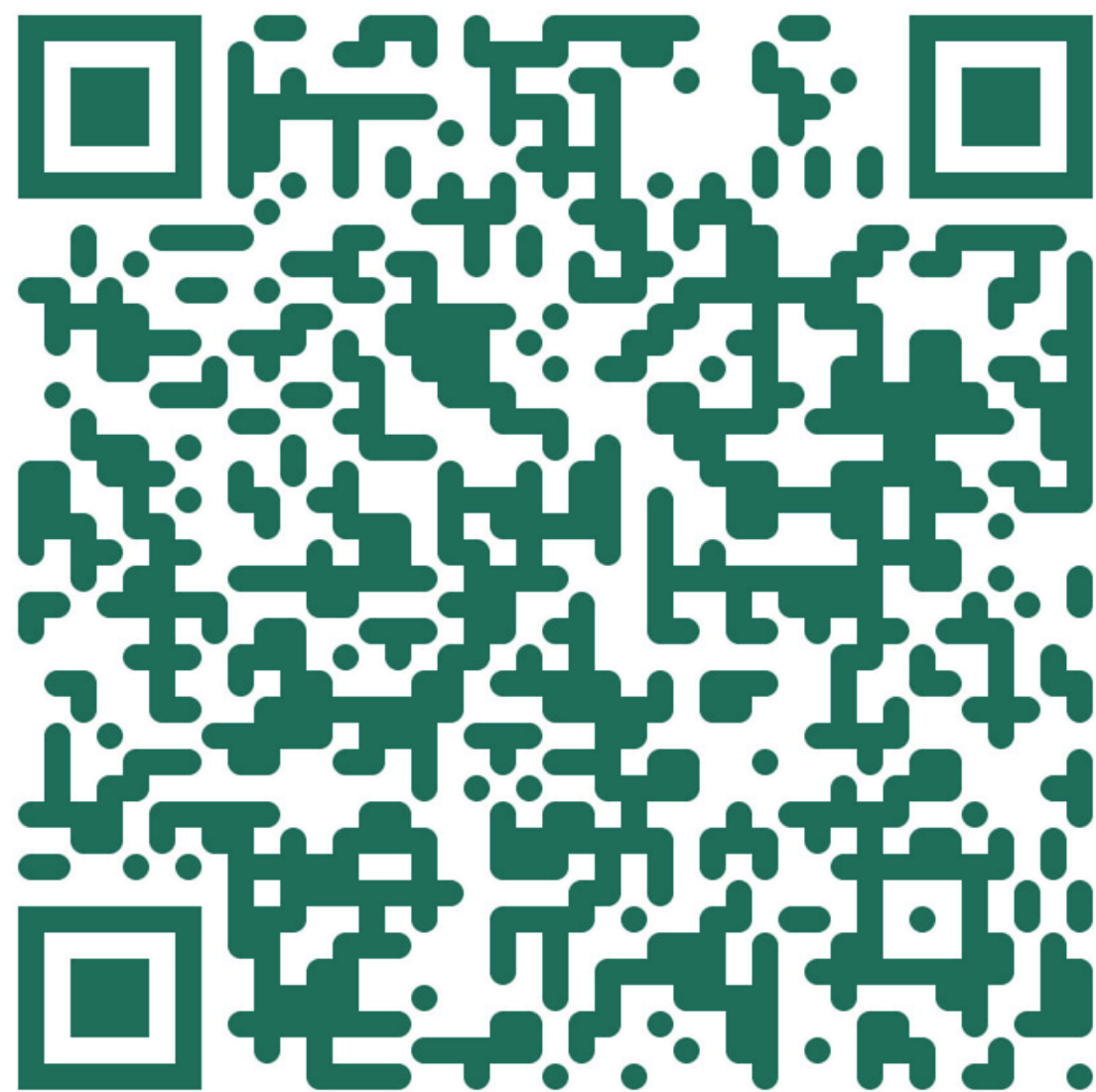
3.4%

Bought Meds Based on SM Advice

Key Takeaways

- Depression, ADHD and Anxiety are the most commonly self-diagnosed conditions.
- Young adults (18-24) make up the large majority of respondents affected.
- Only a small fraction consult a doctor after self-diagnosing — most take no action or self-treat.
- Negative emotions (confusion, doubt, anxiety) are as common as relief after watching this content.

Streamlit App Demo



Recommendations

For Platforms

- Add clear disclaimers on medical / mental-health content
- Surface links to verified professional resources
- Flag content lacking credible sourcing

For Creators

- Cite credible sources for any diagnostic claims
- State clearly this is not a substitute for a doctor
- Avoid definitive diagnostic language

For Users

- Treat self-diagnosis content as a starting point, not a conclusion
- Cross-check with more than one source
- Consult a professional when in doubt



Thank You